

that doesn't make it less of one. The more you can foster autonomy and competence in your kids, the stronger your tribe will be.



My mother, Georgette, at Easter making pastries with her good friend Mary Lenas and others. Georgette believed the simplest family activities could engage children and their friends in a way that forms bonds. You don't see video games here, just children rolling dough.

When you're alone with your kids, focus on spending quality time, not quality cash. I once knew a single mom who didn't have much money for Christmas presents. On Christmas Eve, she took her four kids to the dollar store and gave them each \$5 to buy presents for each other. Guess what? They had a blast. That mom spent a grand total of \$25 on Christmas presents. And yet her four kids, now adults, remember that year fondly, because they had to come together in the trenches of poverty to make the most of it. Their mother had done an excellent job of teaching them to be grateful for what they had: namely, each other.

Money Mistake: *Getting Remarried Is Too Expensive*

The Fix: *Wrong! Consider the Long-Term Financial Benefits*